Trap 808

Sounds like: Metro Boomin-era trap sub with knock

ACCURACY B

Close enough to fool most ears.

NOT YET TESTED - settings are a starting point; trust your ears

WHAT YOU NEED (in this order)

`SubTractor -> Scream 4 -> MClass Compressor`

Starting material: MIDI notes only — no audio source needed

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP

1. SubTractor: Osc 1 waveform 4 (sine). Polyphony 1, Legato ON, Portamento ~40 for the trap slide between notes.

2. Amp envelope: A 0, D 90+, S 0 for boom that decays — or S 80 for held 808s you gate with note length. R ~30.

3. The knock: Mod envelope -> destination Osc Pitch, Amount ~40–55, A 0, D ~25, S 0. Every note now starts with a fast pitch drop — that transient IS the knock.

4. Filter 1: LP24, freq ~70%, no resonance. Just taming harmonics from the saturation to come.

5. Scream 4: Damage type Tape, Damage 25–40. This adds harmonics so the 808 is audible on phone speakers. More Damage = more mids = more "distorted 808" as a style choice.

6. MClass Compressor: ratio 4:1, fast attack, ~3 dB reduction — evens out note-to-note level so the sub is constant.

7. Play it low: F1–B1 range. Write the pattern, then tune 808 notes to the song key — an out-of-key 808 ruins everything above it.

Why this works

An 808 is a sine with a pitch-drop transient; saturation folds sub energy up into audible mids.

Why this order

Scream before the compressor: saturation changes level dynamics, and the comp should even out the FINAL sound.

Reason trick

Combinator 2: map macro 1 to Scream Damage ("dirt"), macro 2 to Mod Env Amount ("knock"). Save as "My 808.cmb". Sidechain note: to duck it under the kick, use the channel compressor's sidechain input fed from the kick channel — Reason's mixer does this natively, no CV hacks needed.

The skill you just learned
Transients can be synthesized with pitch envelopes — the same trick makes kicks, toms, and lasers.

Worth buying?
None needed. If you want instant variety, sample packs beat synthesis for exotic 808s.